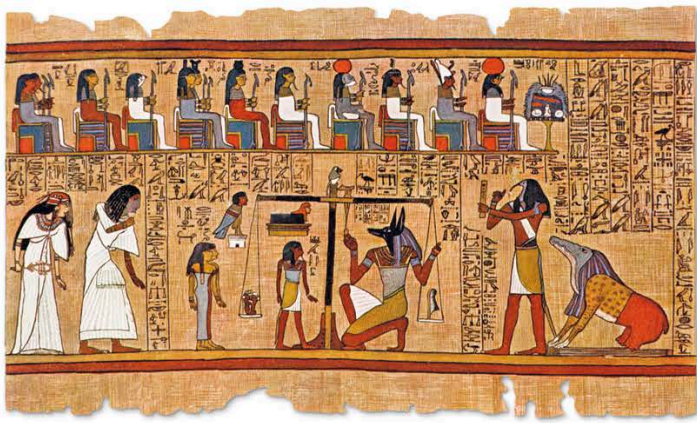




▲ MAGIC SPELLS

The ancient Egyptians were often buried with a collection of spells to help them travel through the underworld. The spells acted as a passport to the kingdom of Osiris. Here, a person is tested by having their heart weighed against the Feather of Truth.



▲ LUXOR TEMPLE

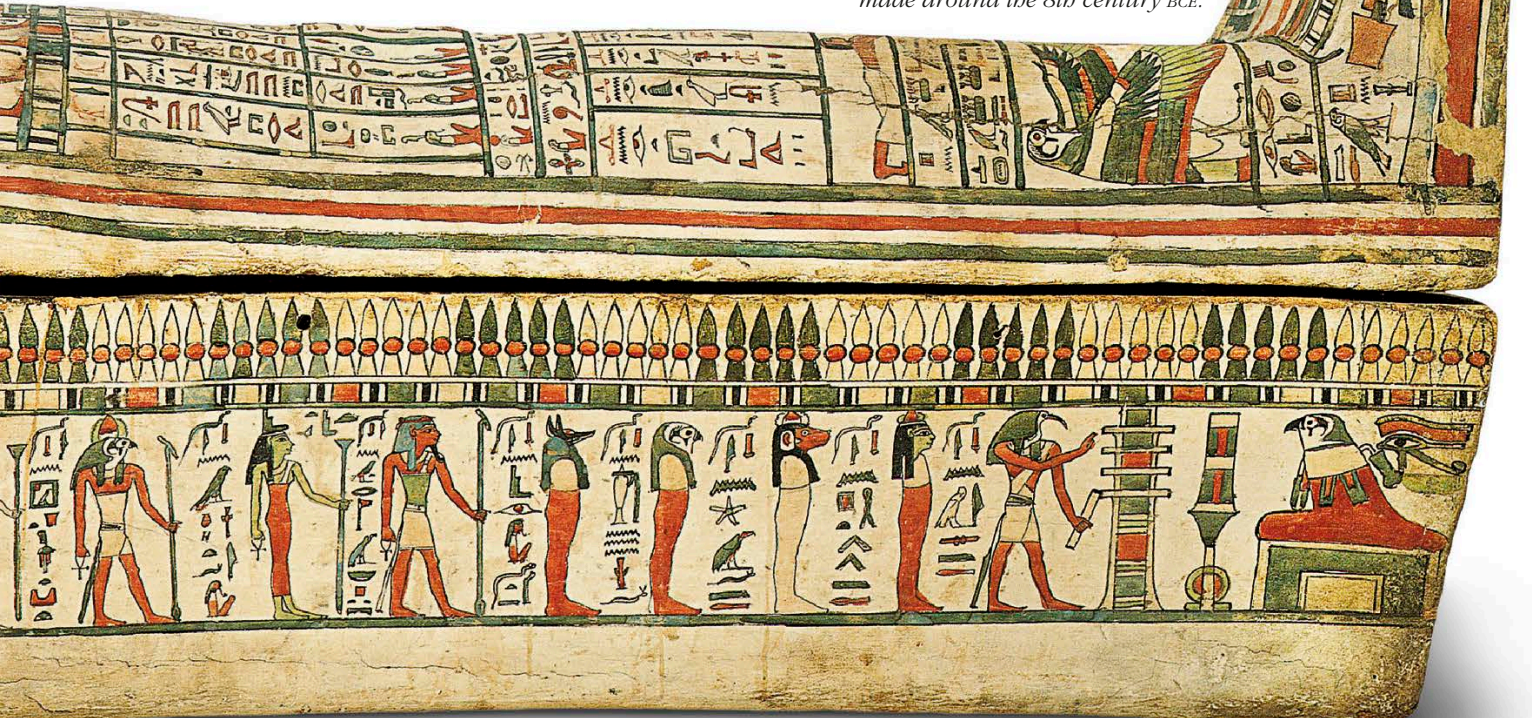
Unlike most temples, which were dedicated to particular gods, the great temple of Luxor was dedicated to the Royal Ka, the divine soul of the pharaoh. Every year a great festival called Opet was held here, during which the living pharaoh was reborn as a god.

◀ MUMMIFICATION

Egyptians believed that though they could live again after death, their soul would still need a physical body and so they developed a ritual to preserve the dead, known as mummification. Priests wearing the mask of the god Anubis, who oversaw the process, removed the inner organs, dried the flesh, stuffed the body, and wrapped it in linen bandages.

MUMMY CASE ▼

For added protection, a mummy was placed in a case, which was shaped like a body and covered in magic spells. The case was another substitute body for the dead person. The mummy case below belonged to a man called Pensenhor, and was made around the 8th century BCE.



Obelisk made of pink granite

